lovingly made by:
me

(the people who know me will know i have made this, but otherwise, i've given you all i would like you to know)

spread the word!
make more of me and leave them places!

PDF here:
https://katypus.github.io/dedistractionzine/

De-Distractioning Your Electronics: A Guide for Zombies

zobny has an 18 hour daily screentime

why you should listen to me:
1. gay
2. hot
3. good at computers
4. i do most of these myself and my life is great

Table of Contents

1. Kill short form content on your phone (instagram, youtube, tiktok)
2. clean up your computer browsing! (adblockers, VPNs)
3. posting responsibly on social media
4. Books! (ebooks, pirating galore!)
5. your to do list

TO DO LIST:

TO DO LIST:

i've left the last pages empty for you guys! imagine all the time you can get back from your phone, from distractions that ultimately make you miserable. imagine all you can do with that time now! what kind of person do you want to be? what kinds of things do you want to do?

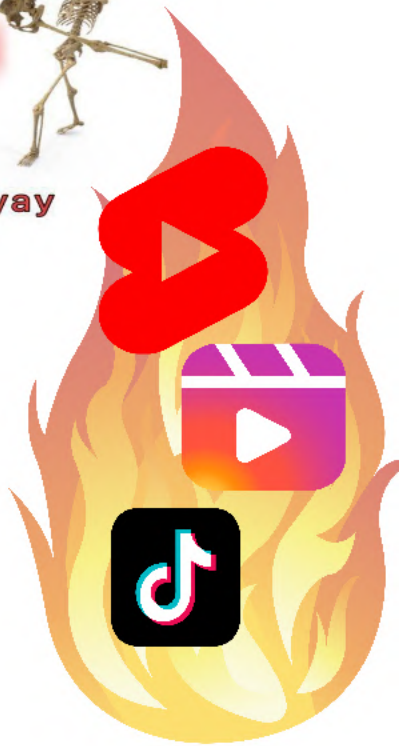
here's some ideas just to get started:

- write a book
- learn to crochet
- learn to draw
- play more sports

NOW YOU!

kill short form content on phone

guy who hasn't read a real book in 5 years: i love rotting my attention span and staying in bed scrolling for so long that i feel physically ill



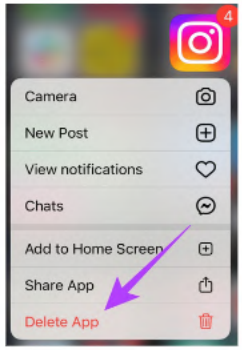
(jk its not your fault, its not your fault and I love you and we can fix it)

How to un-reel and un-short your YT and IG

(while keeping the other functionalities - improvement is a step by step process and few things are 100% evil)

1. delete the app

** for iphone users! android users, u can skip this step



from now on, ur going to use instagram + youtube by going on safari

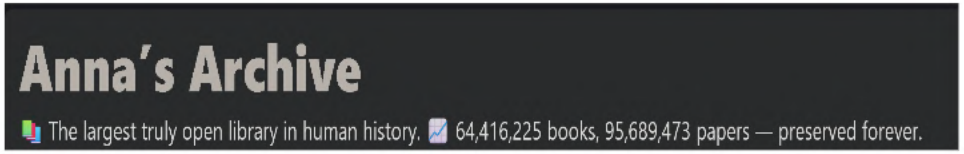
2. Download ScrollGuard from the App Store/Google Play Store

3. Follow the setup instructions that come up when you first open the ScrollGuard app

ebooks

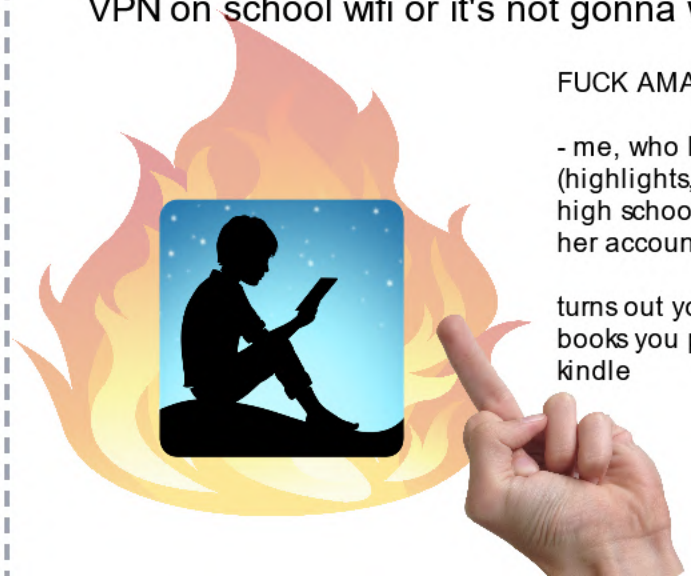
can't let go of that sweet sweet phone? don't have room in your dorm for real books? love the highlighting functionality of ebooks? lemme offer you some options:

the libby app for library ebooks! (works on mobile and online)



can't borrow? pirate!

(go on annas archive's wikipedia page to see which links are currently active. also, you're gonna need a VPN on school wifi or it's not gonna work (duh))



FUCK AMAZON KINDLE

- me, who lost her entire kindle library (highlights, comments, and all) in high school after amazon shut down her account bc it got hacked

turns out you don't actually own the books you pay for when you buy on kindle

YOU MIGHT BE WONDERING...

now that I have all this free time, what do I do with myself?

well man... do you remember books? that medium that contains so much of our civilizations' knowledge? Haven't you seen the news about our growing illiteracy crisis?

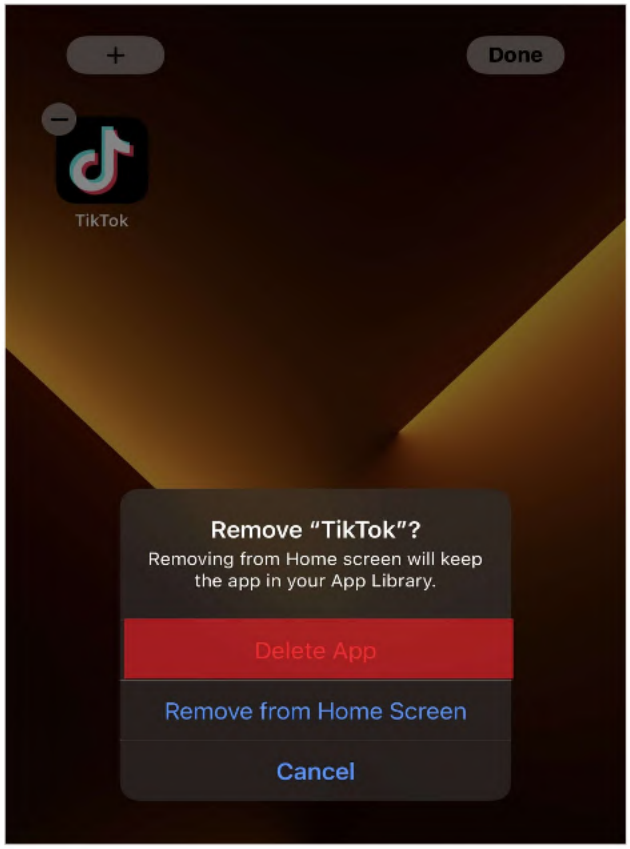
READ A BOOK! Get a Princeton Public Library card (free for students) or browse the first floor of firestone for books that look interesting and READ THEM

Not sure what books to read?

this is a list of the top 1000 books by ratings on goodreads - see which ones you've read, which ones you've heard of, and which ones you wanna read!

How to un-TikTok TikTok

step 1: delete app



(there's no saving this one, I fear - it's all short-form content, and it's all addictive. download the videos you've saved + are important to you, and then delete it. you'll be ok.)

Clean up your computer browsing

bloat that makes your computer sound like a spaceship taking off and feel like a hot stove

stuff that makes your computer run at 1 FPS

cookies

ads

trackers

annoying pop-ups

posting responsibly on social media

protect your neighbors, especially at times like these

DO'S:

1. GET PERMISSION from anyone who is in the picture you are posting (even people in the background - if you can't get their permission, follow the rest of these tips)

2. USE A VPN + DISCONNECT FROM SCHOOL WIFI when posting (eduroam can track your exact location)

DON'TS

1. DON'T post controversial takes on public accounts that are directly connected to your real name (ESPECIALLY if you're an international student)

2. Don't post a photo directly after taking it. SCRUB THE METADATA using a third-party app like ViewExif. Photos come with all types of data that can be seen by platforms and companies, like location, time, and even identifiable people

using duckduckgo instead of Google as your default search engine

this is another privacy-valuing move, and honestly google's kinda been going dow n the drain recently anyw ay, so there's very little quality of life difference

once again these instructions are for firefox

Open the Search panel

1. Click the menu button ≡ and select Settings.
2. Select Search in the left pane.

General
Home
Search
Privacy & Security
Sync
AI Controls
Firefox Labs
More from Mozilla

Search
Default search engine
Google
Show search terms in the address bar on results pages
Search engine suggestions
Show search suggestions
Show search suggestions before browsing history in address bar results
Search suggestions in private windows
Trending search suggestions Learn more

**pro tip: replace your phone's google app with the duckduckgo app

Default search engine

Firefox lets you choose the search engine you wish to use in the address bar and search bar.

- **Show search terms in the address bar on results pages:** Select this setting to show the search term you entered, in the address bar on the results page for your default search engine. Deselect this setting to show the URL instead. This setting is hidden if you have added a separate Search bar to your toolbar.

Use the drop-down menu under *Default search engine* to choose the search engine you wish to use by default.

Search
Default search engine
Google
Google
Amazon.com
Bing
DuckDuckGo
eBay
Perplexity
Wikipedia (en)
<- choose duckduckgo here
ess bar on results pages
efore browsing history in address bar results
te windows
Trending search suggestions Learn more

SWITCH TO FIREFOX

any person who cares at all about data privacy (especially activists!) needs to switch to firefox

if you're someone who doesn't gaf about privacy, here are some other reasons to switch:

- better browser extension library (want youtube without ads? paywall blockers?)
- scroll through tabs at the top of your screen instead of trying to click on teeny tiny little icons
- better memory utilization (make your computer less hot, make your computer last longer)

- look at him face

if u were using chrome, it's even easier to switch! Firefox has a built in chrome -> firefox pipeline that saves all your bookmarks, passwords, form autofill data, extensions, etc

Import your Chrome data to Firefox

Before you begin, save any open tabs in Chrome by bookmarking them into a new folder in your Chrome bookmarks bar (for example, you can name it "Open Tabs").

1. Download and install Firefox

Go to the Firefox download page and install the latest version of Firefox.

2. Exit Google Chrome

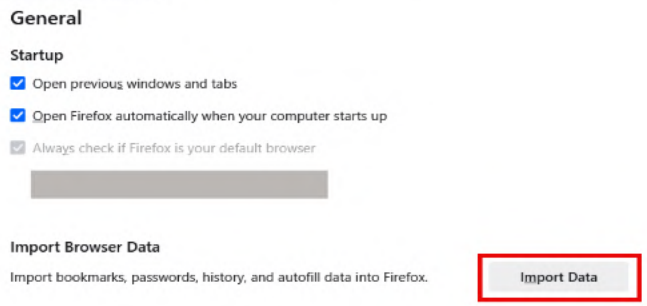
Before importing data, make sure Chrome is closed. Click the three-dot menu and select **Exit**.

3. Open Firefox

When you open Firefox for the first time, the Import Tool may appear automatically, but if it doesn't:

1. Click the menu button ≡ in the top-right corner.

1. Select Settings.
2. In the General panel, scroll down to *Import Browser Data*.
3. Click Import Data.



other helpful plugins (my personal setup)

AdBlocker for YouTube™
Removes all annoying ads and banners from YouTube!

Unhook - Remove YouTube Recommended & Shorts
Hide YouTube related videos, shorts, comments, suggestions wall, homepage recommendations, trending, and other distractions.

SponsorBlock for YouTube - Skip Sponsorships
Skip sponsorships, subscription begging and more on YouTube videos. Report sponsors on videos you watch to save others' time.

YouTube Search Fixer
Remove all distracting YouTube search suggestions, redirect shorts and much more!

i used to be really addicted to youtube, can you tell

Privacy Badger
Automatically learns to block hidden trackers. Made by leading digital rights nonprofit EFF to stop companies from spying on you.

DuckDuckGo Privacy Essentials
Privacy, simplified. Protect your data as you search and browse: tracker blocking, smarter encryption, private search, and more.

Bypass Paywalls Clean (c)
Bypass Paywalls of news sites

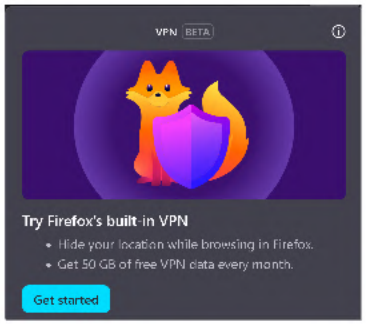
download this one ^ from here: https://gitflic.ru/project/magnolia1234/bypass-paywalls-firefox-clean

VPNs

A VPN (virtual private network) hides your ip address (and by extension your location) from your internet service provider.

If you are on campus, using eduroam, EDUROAM CAN AND WILL track and log all of your online activity, and it will be connected to the name and ip address you signed onto eduroam with.

if you use a vpn, then:
- your online activity will be encrypted
- your location/IP address will be encrypted



firefox has a built in VPN but it's limited to 50GB every month - consider investing in a subscription to ProtonVPN, ExpressVPN, or Surfshark: they also work on your phone!

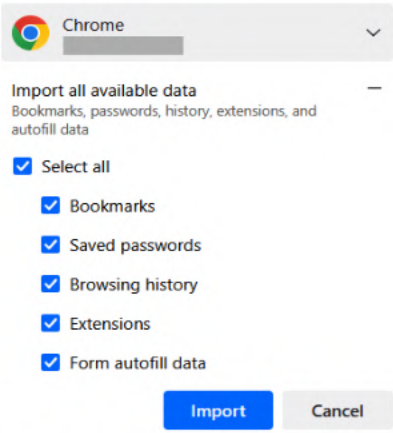
Proton VPN ExpressVPN Surfshark

4. Choose what to import

1. In the import tool, select **Google Chrome** from the list of browsers.
2. Choose the data you want to import:

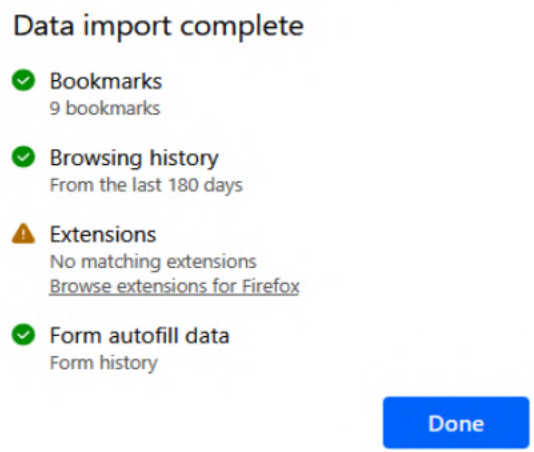
- Bookmarks
- Saved passwords
- Browsing history
- Extensions
- Form autofill data

Import browser data



5. Complete the import

1. Click **Import** to begin.
2. Once the import is finished, click **Done**.



AdBlockers (computer)

*these instructions are for firefox bc you should've switched to firefox

1. go to the Mozilla addons website: addons.mozilla.org

2.

AdBlockers (phone)

For iPhones:

1. go to the app store
2. download AdGuard
3. follow instructions in app

For Androids:

1. go to the website https://adguard.com/en/adguard-android/overview.html, or search up 'adguard for androids'
2. find and press download button
3. follow instructions in app